



BEFORE

Robert E. Lee's invasion of the North began with an advance into Pennsylvania, which initially met little Union resistance.

ORDERS AND COUNTER-ORDERS

As advance elements of General Richard Ewell's Confederate corps **crossed the Mason-Dixon Line**, local residents either fled or tried to hide their possessions from **Southern foraging parties**. Lee now ordered Ewell to divide his corps. One division marched toward York, capturing that city in late June, but **could not cross the Susquehanna River** because Union militia burned the only bridge. Another column headed up the **Cumberland Valley toward Carlisle**, to strike Harrisburg from that direction. But before they could cross the river, Lee recalled his scattered army to **concentrate near Cashtown**. The Federal army was drawing near and Lee wanted to be ready.

LINCOLN RELIEVES HOOKER

Slow to react to Lee's initial movements north in June, **Union general Joseph Hooker**, in command of the Army of the Potomac, **lost his remaining credibility** with Abraham Lincoln. On June 28, Lincoln replaced him with **Major General George G. Meade**.

A decision by Union cavalry commander Brigadier General John Buford precipitated the battle. At the end of June 1863, his division of the Army of the Potomac was near the town of Gettysburg, Pennsylvania, when he learned that the Confederates were coming quickly in his direction. At the same time, Union infantry corps were moving up from Maryland. Realizing the danger of the Confederates reaching Gettysburg first, Buford made a stand on the ridges west of Gettysburg in a bid to hold them off until the Federals could mass and hold the high ground (Cemetery Hill, Culp's Hill, and Cemetery Ridge) south of town. Lee had no intention of fighting at Gettysburg, but Buford's stand forced him to engage before he was ready.

Early on July 1, Southern troops under Brigadier General Henry Heth blundered into Buford's men along the Chambersburg Pike and were forced to deploy. Although Buford's troopers had the edge in firepower with their breech-loading carbines, Heth's men began to push them back—but not fast enough. By mid-morning, Buford's tired command had received support from the First Corps under Major General John Reynolds. Intense fighting erupted between Reynolds's veteran troops and Confederate divisions under Heth and Major General Dorsey Pender. Reynolds was shot from his horse as